SAEED SHAHRIAR

AI Search Lead (GEO / AEO)

Generative & Answer Engine Optimization · AI Citation Tracking · Technical SEO · Claude Code

Bali, Indonesia (Remote · APAC, EMEA and EST overlap)

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

AI search lead with 10+ years in digital content and search, six of them leading SEO in-house for a North American software company. I optimize sites to be cited by ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini and Google AI Overviews through structured data, entity coverage and answer-first content, then track the cited sources for each priority query and close the gaps page by page. I work AI-native with Claude Code and Codex, and I research model behaviour first-hand. Delivered **562,000+** additional annual organic visits and a **300%** lift in non-branded rankings.

CORE SKILLS

AI Search / GEO / AEO: Generative Engine Optimization (GEO), Answer Engine Optimization (AEO), LLM optimization, Google AI Overviews, AI citation tracking, entity optimization, answer-first and structured content, featured snippets

Technical SEO: Schema markup / structured data (JSON-LD), Core Web Vitals, crawlability and indexing, site architecture, internal linking, log-file analysis, international SEO, technical audits

AI tools & workflows: Claude Code, custom Claude skills, Model Context Protocol (MCP), OpenAI Codex CLI, ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini, prompt engineering, human-in-the-loop review

Strategy & analytics: Keyword research, search intent mapping, topic clusters, on-page optimization, competitor analysis, KPI dashboards, CRO, GA4, Google Search Console, Looker Studio, SEMrush, Ahrefs, Screaming Frog

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Independent SEO & AI Search Consultant · Co-founder, Mersa — Jan 2026 – Present

Remote (Bali, Indonesia) · Agencies and clinics across Southeast Asia

- Build GEO/AEO playbooks (citation-worthy statistics, structured answers, entity-rich pages) and track which sources ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini and Google AI Overviews cite for each client's priority queries.
- Grew a Bali dental clinic's organic visibility by **30%** through Core Web Vitals remediation, schema deployment, entity coverage and topic-cluster content for local and overseas patients.
- Designed a Claude random-number experiment (**221** prompts across Haiku, Sonnet and Opus); the chart reached **1M** views, **4.8k** upvotes and **517** comments on r/dataisbeautiful in about a day.
- Built AI-augmented audit and reporting workflows (Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini, custom prompt libraries) that cut deliverable turnaround time by **40%** while maintaining analysis quality.
- Co-founded Mersa (mersa.biz), a digital marketing agency in Bali serving businesses across Bali and Southeast Asia; I own search, the website and the AI workflows behind delivery.

Webnus · Growth Marketing Lead (SEO & CRO)

Nov 2019 – Dec 2025

Ontario, Canada (Remote) · WordPress plugin and theme company serving North American markets

- Increased annual organic traffic by **562,000+ visits** across a portfolio of WordPress product sites by owning the SEO roadmap: technical audits, Core Web Vitals remediation and topic-cluster content restructuring.
- Grew non-branded keyword rankings by **300%** by resolving crawl and indexing issues and deploying schema markup across key page templates.
- Led cross-functional engineering and content teams across EMEA and EST time zones to pilot GEO/AEO tactics, structuring content for visibility in AI Overviews and answer engines.
- Managed a **$6,000/month** Google Ads budget end to end, achieving **150% ROAS** and a **30%** conversion-rate lift through CRO and intent-aligned landing pages.
- Built AI-augmented KPI reporting in Looker Studio (ChatGPT, Gemini, prompt engineering) that cut stakeholder meeting time by **30%** while improving data accuracy.

Shatel · Content Strategy Manager

Jan 2015 – Oct 2018

Tehran, Iran · Iran's largest private ISP

- Managed digital content strategy for a telecom provider serving **2M+ users**, aligning content with acquisition and retention goals.
- Oversaw content operations for Namava, a leading VOD/streaming platform, sustaining engagement for millions of daily active users.
- Built a self-service knowledge base that reduced support tickets by **40%**.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Engineering

Tehran Azad University · Tehran, Iran

CERTIFICATIONS

- HubSpot Academy: SEO Basics, On-Page & Technical SEO, Link Building, Rich Results Optimization
- Google Ads: Measurement Certification
- SEMrush Academy: SEO Toolkit Fundamentals

LANGUAGES

English: Full Professional Proficiency · Persian (Farsi): Native